RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

18 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 2:51 AM, Sunday 18 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 340 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 41 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 8,970 minutes at 3:00 AM; Dammam moving since 2:04 AM after a 1:15 to 2:04 AM halt

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 8,970 minutes at 3:00 AM; closure NOTAM A3604/26 lapsed at midnight and GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 340 flights cancelled for Sunday so far (59% of scheduled).
- Coalition says it intercepted and destroyed a drone in the Riyadh region at 1:39 AM; no new official alert or interception since.
- Dammam airport moving again since 2:04 AM after a 49-minute halt (1:15 to 2:04 AM); 1 takeoff and 3 landings in the last hour, latest flynas XY895 from Cairo at 2:49 AM.
- Air India and Air India Express have suspended Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah flights until 24 October.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (8962 min).

340	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

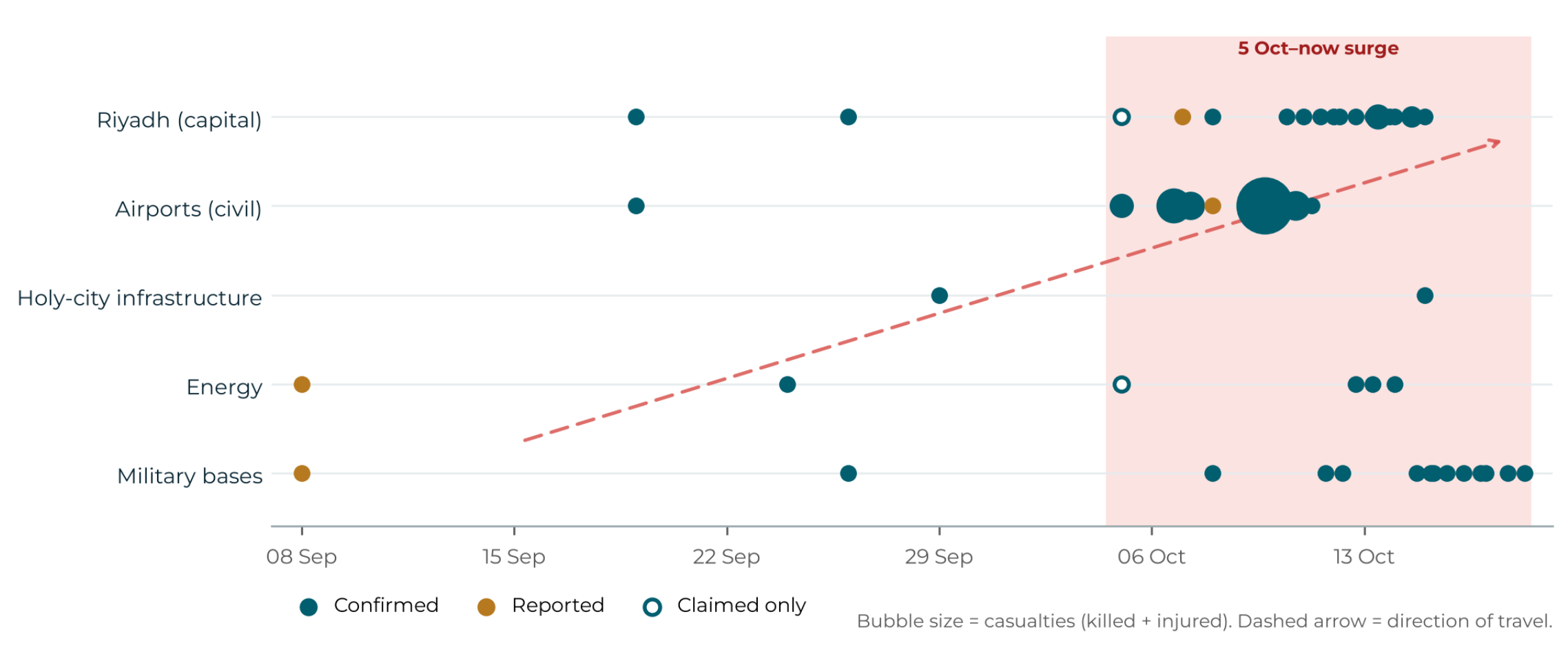
1 takeoff and 3 landings in the last hour.

41	1/3	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (8,970 min at 3:00 AM); no GACA reopening announcement after NOTAM A3604/26 lapsed at midnight
- Dammam halt 1:15 to 2:04 AM (49 min) ended; 1 takeoff and 3 landings since
- No new official alert or interception since the Coalition's 1:39 AM Riyadh-region drone interception
- Unverified: social relays of a 2:17 AM Civil Defense alert for Riyadh, Abha and Khamis Mushait, not posted by @SaudiDCD

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 18 OCT



48 sourced events since 8 September (42 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region (18 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 2:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

UNVERIFIED ALERT **2:17 AM AST · Riyadh**

Social accounts relay a Civil Defense early-warning alert for Riyadh, Abha and Khamis Mushait (all-clear relayed at 2:43 AM); not posted by @SaudiDCD, may repeat the 12:05 AM alert. X accounts citing Saudi Civil Defense

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 4, alerts 6, all-clears 5.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh airport still halted after its closure NOTAM lapsed; Dammam resumes after a 49-minute halt; Coalition downs a drone in the Riyadh region

Checked at 2:53 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA / Al Ekhbariya **· 1:39 AM** · published 1:39 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA carried it at 1:41 AM (Arabic) and 1:44 AM (English), Al Ekhbariya at 1:41 and 2:03 AM; checked 2:53 AM

The Coalition spokesman said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region. No casualties, debris or damage were reported in the post, and no new Civil Defense alert for Riyadh was posted after the 12:11 AM all-clear.

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts relay a Civil Defense alert for Riyadh, Abha and Khamis Mushait at 2:17 AM, all-clear at 2:43 AM**

X accounts citing Saudi Civil Defense **· 2:17 AM** · posts at 2:17 AM and 2:43 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (Arabic, translated); not on @SaudiDCD's X account as of 2:53 AM; checked 2:53 AM

Several accounts posted that Civil Defense had issued an early-warning alert for Riyadh, Abha and Khamis Mushait at 2:17 AM and declared the danger over at 2:43 AM. Civil Defense's own account has not posted these, and the same three cities were alerted at 12:05 AM, so this may be a repeat of the earlier alert.

UNVERIFIED DMM **Social accounts report Dammam flights stopped and two aircraft holding around 1:57 to 2:28 AM**

X accounts (@MakkahUpdate and others) **· 2:19 AM** · posts 1:57 to 2:43 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; board shows a 1:15 to 2:04 AM halt, then landings at 2:04, 2:24 and 2:49 AM; checked 2:53 AM

Social accounts said flights at King Fahd International had stopped and that two aircraft were circling in holding patterns. The Flightradar24 board matches a halt from 1:15 to 2:04 AM, but shows traffic moving again since, with landings at 2:24 and 2:49 AM. No official statement on Dammam has been posted.

CONFIRMED **Air India and Air India Express suspend Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah flights until 24 October**

Air India travel advisory (@airindia) / Economic Times, The Hindu **· 12:12 PM** · advisory posted Sat 17 Oct; reported by BusinessLine at 12:12 PM AST and The Hindu at 1:17 PM AST; social posts recirculating it at 1:39 AM; checked 1:52 AM

Air India said it and Air India Express have temporarily suspended flights to and from Jeddah, Riyadh and Dammam until 24 October 2026, offering a free date change for bookings made by 15 October and refunds for cancelled flights. Indian media report IndiGo and Akasa Air have also suspended Saudi operations.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: two Houthi ballistic missiles fired toward Khamis Mushait intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA **· 12:52 AM** · published 12:52 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA carried it at 12:54 AM; checked 12:57 AM

The Coalition spokesman said two ballistic missiles launched by the Houthis toward Khamis Mushait were intercepted and destroyed. No casualties or debris were reported in the post.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense early-warning alerts in Riyadh, Abha and Khamis Mushait, then all-clears**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) **· 12:05 AM** · alerts 12:05 to 12:07 AM, all-clears Riyadh 12:11 AM, Abha and Khamis Mushait 12:21 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; checked 12:57 AM

Civil Defense issued National Early Warning Platform alerts for Riyadh City at 12:05 AM and for Abha and Khamis Mushait a minute or two later. It declared the danger over in Riyadh at 12:11 AM and in Abha and Khamis Mushait at 12:21 AM. At 12:22 AM it repeated that filming or sharing interceptions or impact sites is punishable.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: two Houthi ballistic-missile launchers destroyed after being used to fire at the Kingdom**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) **· 11:41 PM** · published 11:41 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, English); checked 11:58 PM

The Coalition spokesman posted footage of the targeting and destruction of two ballistic-missile launchers, saying they had been detected being used to launch ballistic missiles towards the Kingdom. The post does not say when those missiles were fired or where they were intercepted.

UNVERIFIED **OSINT account: new Saudi NOTAM A3650 puts Riyadh arrivals and departures on prior permission, signalling a restart**

MenchOsint (X) **· 10:04 PM** · posted 10:04 PM AST Sat 17 Oct; NOTAM text quoted by a single OSINT account, not yet confirmed by GACA; checked 11:58 PM

MenchOsint said two new NOTAMs were issued for Riyadh, including A3650, which makes departing and arriving traffic subject to Prior Permission Required (PPR), and that activity is expected to resume tonight. GACA and the airport have not announced a reopening; the airport's replies to passengers up to 11:19 PM still say to check with the airline.

CONFIRMED **SPA: remote learning in Riyadh and Diriyah extended until next Thursday**

SPA (@SPAregions) **· 10:48 PM** · published 10:48 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 10:57 PM

The Saudi Press Agency announced that remote (distance) learning in Riyadh and Diriyah has been extended until next Thursday. The post gives no reason, but it follows a week of missile and drone attacks on the capital.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official authorities and their airline; no reopening announced**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) **· 10:53 PM** · replies to passengers posted 10:39 to 10:53 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 10:57 PM

In replies to passengers between 10:39 and 10:53 PM, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates they should follow the competent official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It added that once operations resume, passengers can ask about luggage at their airline's baggage-services office in the arrivals area. It gave no reopening time.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (8962 min).

340	—	—	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
177 departures + 163 arrivals, 59% of 580 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:51 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 340 at 2:51 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	177	163	340	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	177 (58%)	163 (59%)	340	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	0	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	1 (100%)	0 (0%)	1	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 23	0 of 9	0 of 32	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	7	21	28	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	18	23	41	FR24 stats panel

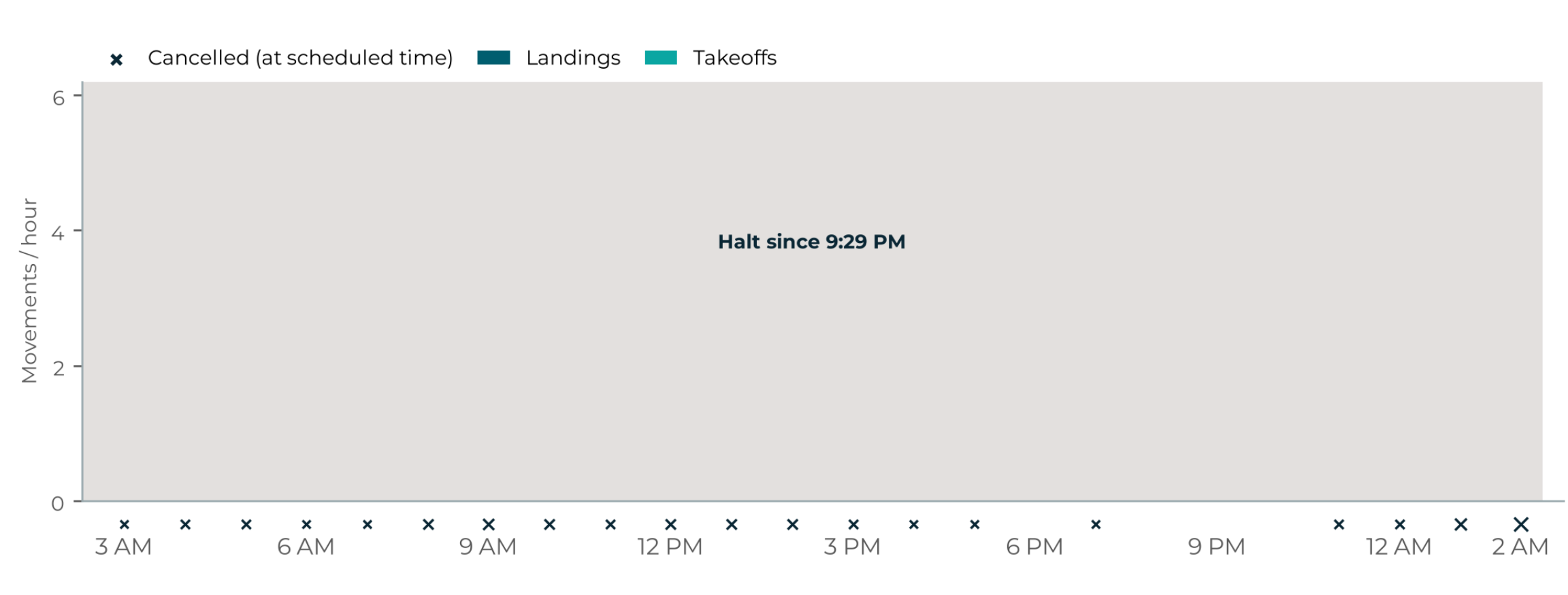
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	222
flynas	65
Qatar Airways	13
Riyadh Air	8
Gulf Air	8

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	96
Madinah	31
Dubai	24
Dammam	22
Doha	15

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



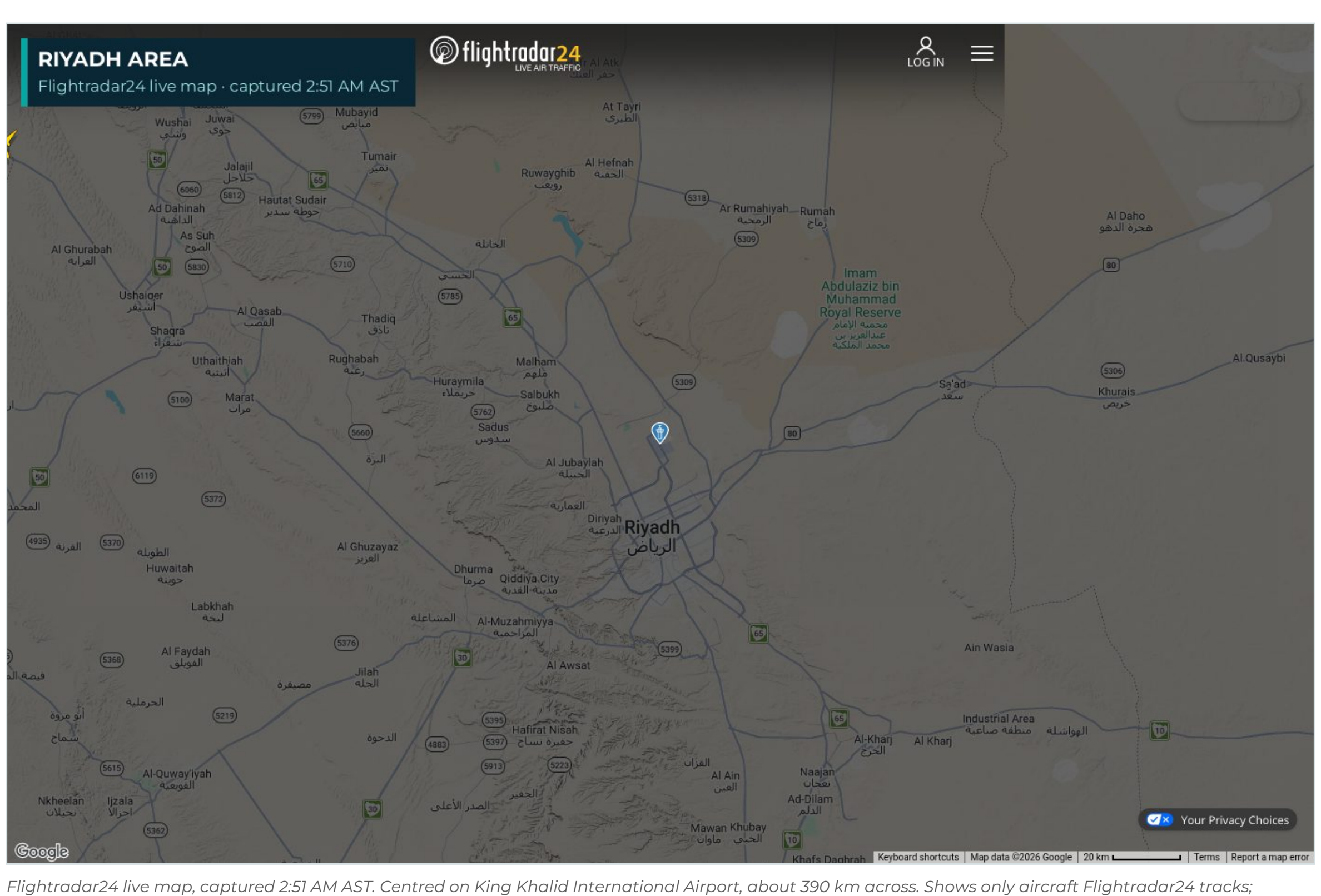
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 3:00 AM Saturday to 2:51 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's halts in the window ran 3:06–4:21 AM, 4:31–5:27 AM, 5:27–7:17 AM, 5:09–6:01 PM, 9:42–11:11 PM, 12:17–1:05 AM and 1:15–2:04 AM; Dammam has been moving since 2:04 AM with no halt open; its latest movement was flynas XY895 landing from Cairo at 2:49 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM 8962 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA


RIYADH AREA

Flightradar24 live map · captured 2:51 AM AST

Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:51 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 1 takeoff and 3 landings in the last hour.

41	2:25 AM	2:49 AM	1	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
21 departures + 20 arrivals, 19% of 216 scheduled.	XY896 to Lucknow, 26 min before 2:51 AM.	XY895 from Cairo, 2 min before 2:51 AM.	3 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:51 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 41 at 2:51 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	21	20	41	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	21 (19%)	20 (19%)	41	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	4 (4%)	3 (3%)	7	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	1 (20%)	1 (25%)	2	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	88 min	84 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	4 of 10	5 of 14	9 of 24	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	0	3	3	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	15	14	29	FR24 stats panel

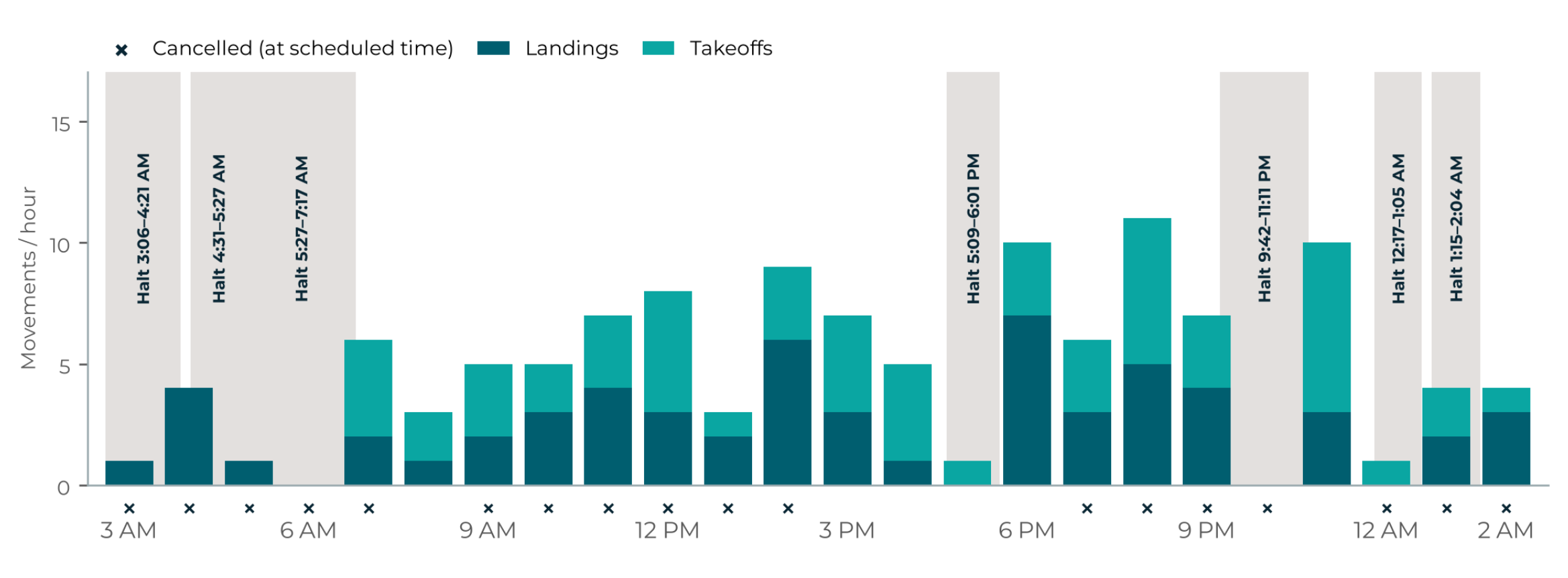
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	22
Egyptair	6
Qatar Airways	6
Turkish Airlines	2
Royal Jordanian	2

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Riyadh	22
Cairo	6
Doha	6
Istanbul	2
Amman	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (58) and landings (60) at DMM per hour from 3:00 AM Saturday to 2:51 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Halt 1:15 to 2:04 AM (49 min); moving since 2:04 AM. 1 takeoff and 3 landings in the last hour.

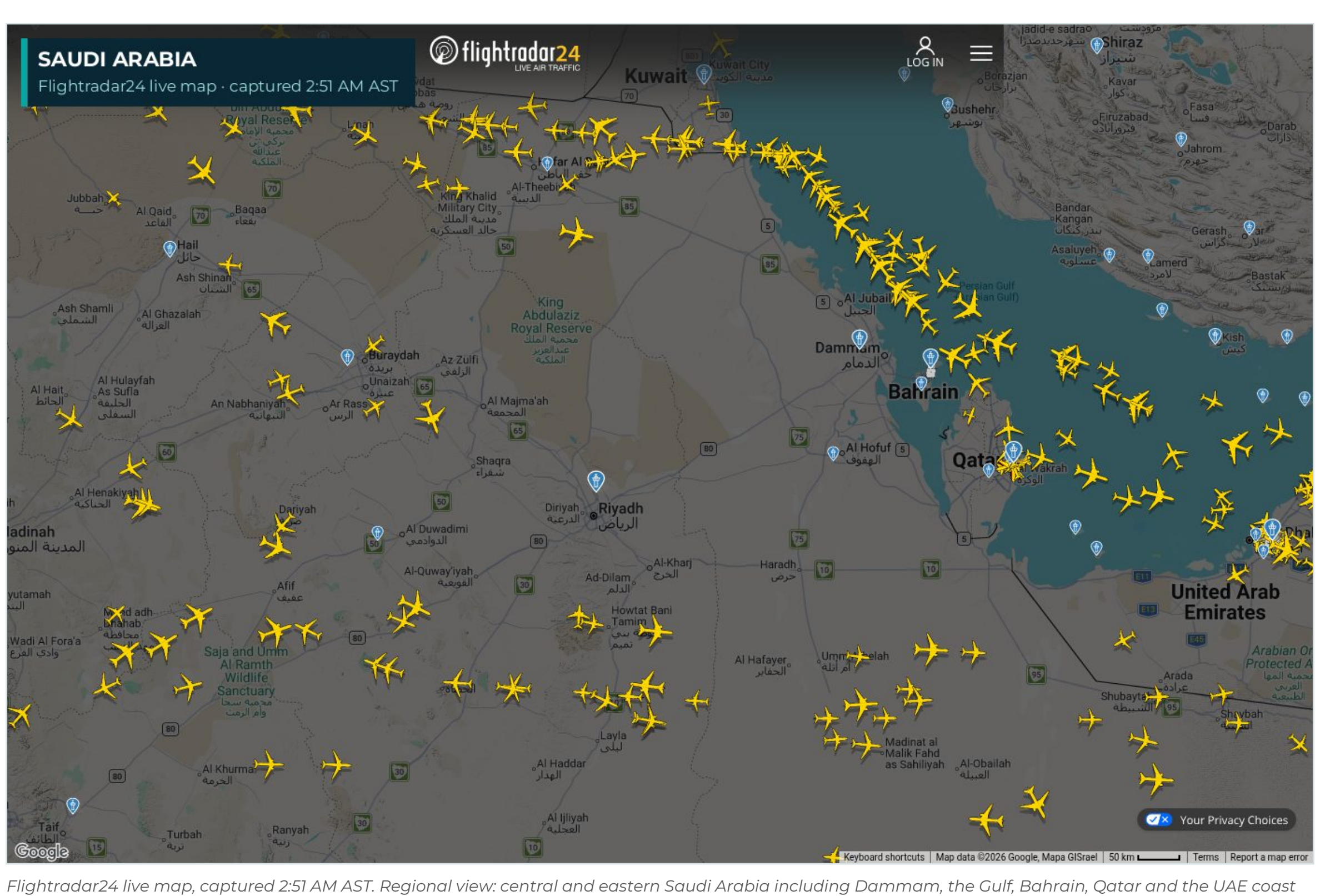
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 1:15–2:04 AM	49 min
Halt 12:17–1:05 AM	48 min
Halt 9:42–11:11 PM	89 min
Halt 5:09–6:01 PM	53 min
Halt 5:27–7:17 AM	109 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts report Dammam flights stopped and two aircraft holding around 1:57 to 2:28 AM** (X accounts (@MakkahUpdate and others) · 2:19 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA


SAUDI ARABIA

Flightradar24 live map · captured 2:51 AM AST

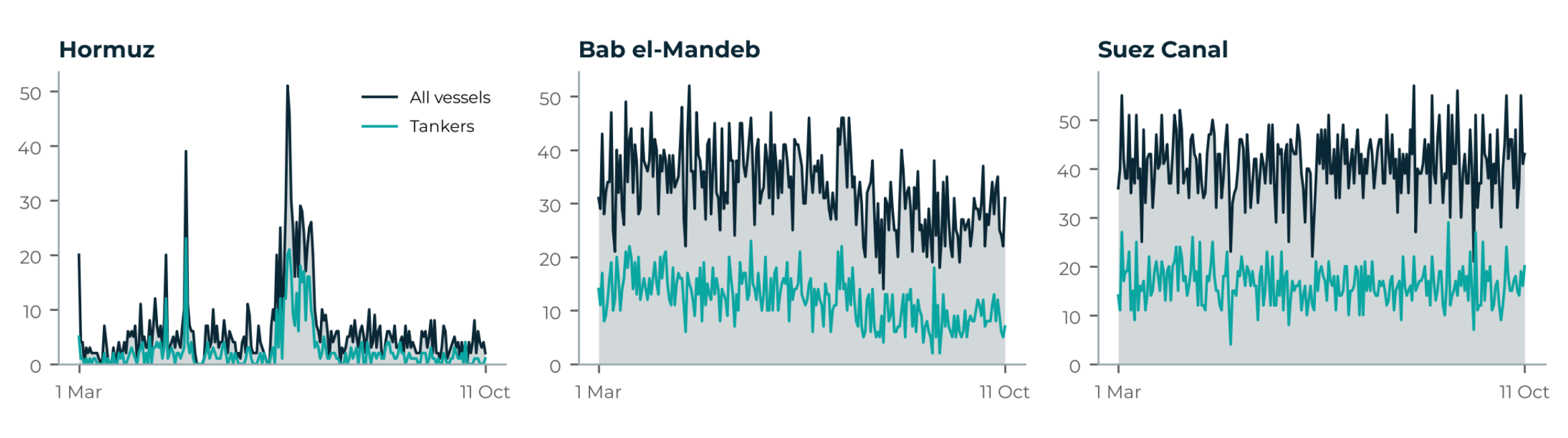
Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:51 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

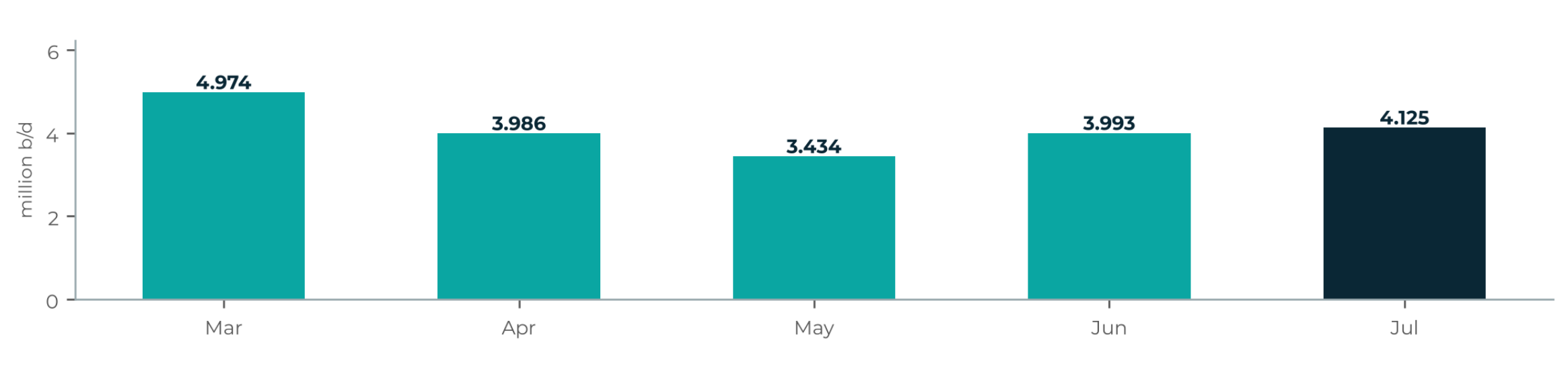
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 2:52 AM, Sun 18 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

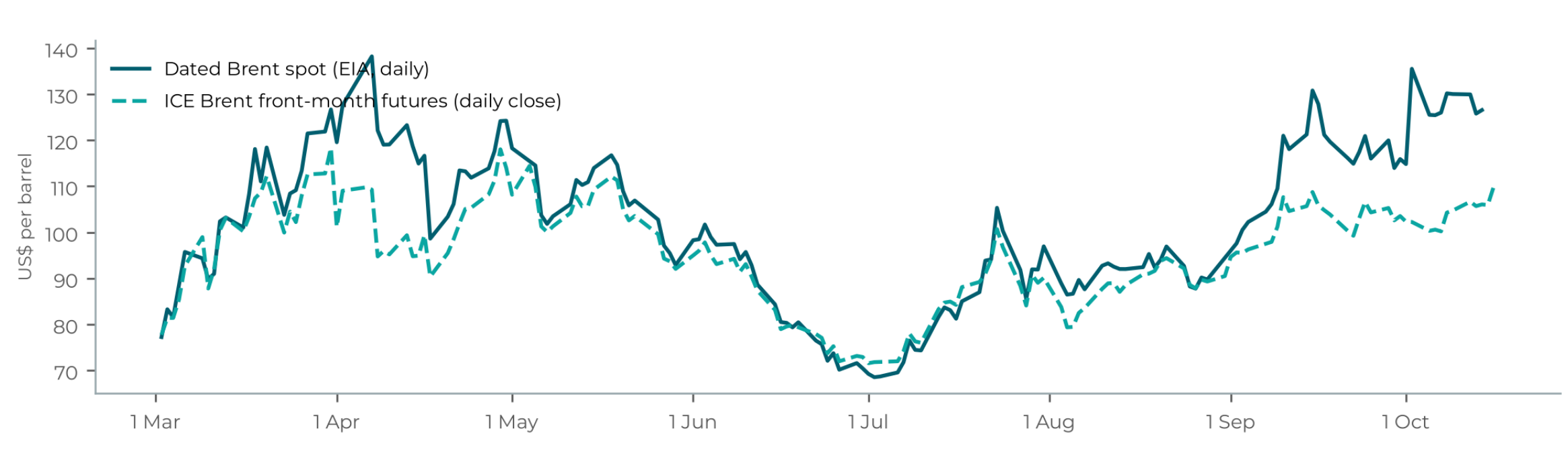


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 2:51 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
2:51 AM, Sun 18 Oct	2:51 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	4:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 4:00 AM